

Pandora Strategy — Universal Design System

Applicable to: Web applications, presentations (PPT/Keynote), PDF documents, posters, printed collateral, social media assets, infographics, email templates, and any branded digital or physical artefact.

1. Design Philosophy

Scandinavian minimalism meets understated luxury. The aesthetic draws from Pandora's brand identity: clean, warm, elegant, and confident without being loud. Every element should feel intentional and restrained. White space is a design tool, not wasted space. The overall impression should be *"premium consulting meets Nordic craft"* — regardless of whether it's rendered on a screen, projected on a wall, or printed on paper.

The Three Words

If you can only remember three words, remember these: **Warm. Restrained. Purposeful.**

2. Colour Palette

2.1 Primary Colours

Role	Name	Hex	RGB	CMYK (Print)	Pantone Nearest
Background	Clean White	#FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	0/0/0/0	White
Text Primary	Warm Charcoal	#2D2926	45, 41, 38	67/62/62/58	Pantone Black 7 C
Accent Primary	Powder Pink	#E8B4BC	232, 180, 188	7/30/12/0	Pantone 693 C

2.2 Secondary Colours

Role	Name	Hex	RGB	Usage
Surface / Card Fill	Warm	#F9F5F2	249,	Card backgrounds, section fills, alternating rows
	Cream		245, 242	
Text Secondary	Soft	#6B5E57	107, 94,	Subtitles, descriptions, metadata, captions
	Taupe		87	
Text Tertiary	Mid	#4A3F3A	74, 63,	Mid-weight body text in panels
	Taupe		58	
Accent Dark	Muted	#8C545E	140, 84,	Footnotes, italic callouts, subtle emphasis
	Rose		94	
Accent Medium	Dusty	#B06B78	176,	Numbered labels, secondary accents
	Rose		107, 120	
Accent Soft	Soft	#D4B8BD	212,	Decorative chevrons, hover states (web), soft borders
	Rose		184, 189	

2.3 Dark / Inverted Palette

Role	Name	Hex	Usage
Dark Background	Warm	#2D2926	Hero sections, inverted panels, closing slides, dark headers
	Charcoal		
Text on Dark	White	#FFFFFF	Primary text on dark backgrounds
Subtext on Dark	Warm	rgba(255,255,255,0.85) or #D9D4D1	Body text on dark backgrounds
	White		
Accent on Dark	Powder	#E8B4BC	Labels, overlines, highlights on dark
	Pink		

2.4 Colour Rules (All Surfaces)

1. **Never use pure black** (#000000). Always use Warm Charcoal (#2D2926).
2. **Never use cold greys.** All neutrals lean warm/brownish (taupe family).
3. **Pink is an accent, not a dominant fill.** Use it for borders, dividers, labels, numbering, and micro-highlights — not large filled areas.
4. **Equal items get equal colour treatment.** Cards in a grid, list items, initiative blocks — all siblings share identical styling. No random colour variation between items of equal weight.

5. **Contrast minimum:** Body text against its background must meet WCAG AA (4.5:1 ratio). Charcoal on white = 14.7:1 ✓. Charcoal on cream = 12.1:1 ✓. White on charcoal = 14.7:1 ✓.
6. **Print consideration:** Powder Pink may appear washed out on some paper stocks. For print, test and consider using Dusty Rose (#B06B78) for small accent elements that must remain visible.

3. Typography

3.1 Font Pairing

Role	Primary Choice	Web Fallback	System Fallback
Headings	Cormorant Garamond (Semi-Bold 600 / Bold 700)	Georgia, 'Times New Roman', serif	Any elegant serif
Body	Source Sans 3 (Light 300 / Regular 400 / Semi-Bold 600)	Calibri, 'Gill Sans', 'Segoe UI', sans-serif	Any humanist sans-serif

Presentation/PDF note: Use Garamond or Cormorant Garamond for headings (whichever is available). Use Calibri Light for body text (standard on Windows/Office). If Calibri is unavailable, substitute Source Sans 3 weight 300.

Google Fonts import: Cormorant Garamond:wght@600;700 + Source Sans 3:wght@300;400;600

3.2 Type Scale

For Web

Element	Size	Weight	Letter Spacing	Line Height
H1 (Hero)	48–56px	700	-0.02em	1.15
H2 (Section)	32–40px	600	-0.01em	1.2
H3 (Card/Panel)	22–26px	600	0	1.3
Body	16–18px	300	0.01em	1.6
Small / Caption	13–14px	400	0.02em	1.5

Overline / Label	11–13px	600	0.15em	1.4
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For Presentations (PPT/Keynote)

Element	Size	Weight	Notes
Slide Title	24–28pt	Bold	Garamond, Warm Charcoal
Section Header	18–20pt	Bold	Garamond, for panel/card titles
Body Text	14–16pt	Light	Calibri Light, never below 14pt
Caption / Note	11–12pt	Light/Italic	Muted Rose or Soft Taupe
Overline Label	8–10pt	Semi-Bold, Uppercase	Letter-spacing 2.5pt, Powder Pink
Data/Number	14–16pt	Bold	For callout numbers

For Print / Posters

Element	Size (A4/Letter)	Size (A1/Poster)	Weight
Main Heading	28–36pt	72–96pt	Bold
Subheading	18–22pt	36–48pt	Semi-Bold
Body	10–12pt	18–24pt	Light/Regular
Caption	8–9pt	14–16pt	Regular
Overline	7–8pt	12–14pt	Semi-Bold, Uppercase, Tracked

3.3 Typography Rules (All Surfaces)

1. **Overline labels** (e.g., "SHARED ENTERPRISE BACKBONE") are always: uppercase, wide-tracked (0.15em / 2.5pt), small size, in Powder Pink or Muted Rose.
2. **Body text** should always feel light and open — use weight 300 (Light) as the default.
3. **Bold is for emphasis only** — highlight key terms within a sentence, never entire paragraphs.
4. **Italic** is reserved for insight callouts, philosophical footnotes, and attribution lines.
5. **Minimum readable size:** 13px on screens, 8pt in print, 14pt in presentations.

4. Spacing & Layout

4.1 Spacing Scale (8px / 8pt base grid)

Token	Web (px)	Presentation (pt)	Print (mm)	Usage
xs	4	4	1	Inner pill/badge padding
sm	8	8	2	Gap between related elements
md	16	14	4	Card internal padding
lg	24	20	6	Gap between cards in a grid
xl	48	36	12	Section breaks
2xl	80	56	20	Major section breaks
3xl	120	—	30	Page-level padding (web only)

4.2 Layout Principles (All Surfaces)

1. **Generous white space.** When in doubt, increase the padding. The design should feel spacious and unhurried.
2. **Content alignment.** Left-align body text. Centre-align only hero statements, callout blocks, and single-line impact phrases.
3. **Grid consistency.** If you have N items of equal weight, they sit in a uniform grid — same size, same spacing, same styling. No exceptions.
4. **Edge margins matter.** Content should never touch the edge of its container. Minimum margin: 36pt in presentations, 24px on web, 15mm in print.

4.3 Surface-Specific Layout

Web: Max content width 1200px, centred. Use CSS Grid for card layouts. Responsive: 3-column → 2-column → single column.

Presentations (16:9): Usable area is approximately 888×512pt within a 960×540pt slide. Title occupies top 60pt. Main content zone: 72–440pt. Bottom zone for callouts/footnotes: 450–528pt.

Print (A4): Margins 20mm all sides. For posters, margins 25–30mm. Use columns (2 or 3) for dense content rather than reducing font size.

5. Components

5.1 Cards / Panels

The fundamental content container across all surfaces.

Property	Web	Presentation	Print
Background	#F9F5F2	Warm Cream fill	5% warm grey tint
Border	1px solid #E8B4BC	0.75pt solid Powder Pink	0.5pt solid Powder Pink
Corner Radius	8px	6pt	2mm
Internal Padding	24px	14–20pt	6mm
Shadow	0 2px 12px rgba(45,41,38,0.06)	None (flat)	None

Rule: All cards in a set are identical. Same fill, same border, same radius, same size.

5.2 Accent Dividers

A signature element — a short pink line beneath headings.

Property	Web	Presentation	Print
Width	120px	140pt	30mm
Height	2px	2pt	0.5pt
Colour	Powder Pink	Powder Pink	Powder Pink
Alignment	Left (default)	Left	Left

5.3 Pills / Tags / Badges

Small rounded containers for labels, categories, or capability names.

Property	Value
Background	rgba(232, 180, 188, 0.12) (light bg) or rgba(232, 180, 188, 0.18) (dark bg)
Border	1px solid rgba(232, 180, 188, 0.35)

Corner Radius	100px (fully rounded)
Padding	6px 16px (web) / 4pt 10pt (ppt)
Text	13px/9pt, body font, white on dark or charcoal on light

5.4 Dark Panels / Inverted Sections

Used for hero areas, central hub blocks, key callouts, closing sections.

Property	Value
Background	#2D2926 Warm Charcoal
Text	White #FFFFFF for headings, rgba(255,255,255,0.85) for body
Accent	Powder Pink for overlines, labels, small highlights
Corner Radius	8px (web) / 6pt (ppt) / 2mm (print)

5.5 Callout / Insight Line

An italic statement — typically centred, used at the bottom of a section to deliver a key takeaway.

Property	Value
Font	Body font, italic
Size	16px (web) / 11pt (ppt) / 10pt (print)
Colour	Muted Rose #8C545E
Alignment	Centre
Max Width	720px (web) / 80% of content width (ppt/print)

5.6 Numbered Items

When items have sequence numbers (01, 02, 03...), the numbers serve as visual anchors.

Property	Value
Number Colour	Powder Pink #E8B4BC (uniform for all items)
Number Font	Heading font, bold
Number Size	Same as or slightly smaller than the item title

Rule	All numbers in a set use the exact same colour. Never vary.
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6. Hub-and-Spoke / Convergence Diagrams

This is a recurring visual pattern in the system — a central block surrounded by connected elements.

Element	Styling
Central Hub	Dark charcoal fill, rounded corners, white heading text, overline in pink
Spokes	Warm Cream cards, pink border, connected via small chevron arrows
Chevrons/Arrows	Soft Rose #D4B8BD fill, small (14–16pt), no outline
Spoke borders	Uniform Powder Pink — all spokes identical, no colour variation

7. Iconography & Imagery

Icons

- **Style:** Outline / mono-weight line icons. Stroke weight: 1.5px.
- **Recommended sets:** Phosphor Icons (Light), Lucide, Heroicons (Outline).
- **Colour:** #2D2926 on light backgrounds, #E8B4BC on dark backgrounds.
- **Sizing:** 20–24px inline (web), 36–48pt feature blocks (ppt), 64–80px hero decorative.
- **Never use emoji or Unicode symbols.** They render inconsistently and undermine the premium feel.

Photography (if used)

- Editorial-quality, desaturated, warm-toned.
- Avoid stock photography clichés (handshakes, whiteboards, sticky notes).
- Apply a subtle warm colour overlay if needed to match the palette.

Decorative Elements

- Small diamond shapes (◇) in Soft Rose, used sparingly at corners or as section markers.
- Thin horizontal rules in Powder Pink.
- No gradients, no drop shadows on decorative elements, no glow effects.

8. Web-Specific Additions

Skip this section for presentations, print, or static assets.

Interactive States

State	Treatment
Hover (Cards)	Border shifts to #D4B8BD, shadow: 0 4px 20px rgba(232,180,188,0.15)
Hover (Buttons)	Background darkens by one step
Active/Focus	2px outline in Powder Pink, 2px offset
Disabled	Opacity 0.4, no pointer events

Buttons

Variant	Background	Text	Border
Primary	#2D2926	#FFFFFF	None
Primary Hover	#4A3F3A	#FFFFFF	None
Secondary	Transparent	#2D2926	1px #E8B4BC
Secondary Hover	rgba(232,180,188,0.08)	#2D2926	1px #D4B8BD

Motion

- **Transitions:** 200ms ease for colour/opacity. 300ms ease-out for transforms.
- **Scroll animations:** Gentle fade-up (translateY 20px → 0, opacity 0 → 1) with 100ms stagger between siblings.

- **Principle:** Everything should feel calm and deliberate. No bouncing, no spinning, no attention-grabbing effects.

CSS Custom Properties

```
:root {
  --color-bg: #FFFFFF;
  --color-surface: #F9F5F2;
  --color-text-primary: #2D2926;
  --color-text-secondary: #6B5E57;
  --color-text-tertiary: #4A3F3A;
  --color-accent: #E8B4BC;
  --color-accent-dark: #8C545E;
  --color-accent-medium: #B06B78;
  --color-accent-soft: #D4B8BD;
  --color-dark-bg: #2D2926;
  --color-dark-text: #FFFFFF;
  --font-heading: 'Cormorant Garamond', Georgia, serif;
  --font-body: 'Source Sans 3', 'Segoe UI', sans-serif;
  --radius-sm: 6px;
  --radius-md: 8px;
  --radius-lg: 12px;
  --radius-pill: 100px;
  --shadow-card: 0 2px 12px rgba(45, 41, 38, 0.06);
  --shadow-card-hover: 0 4px 20px rgba(232, 180, 188, 0.15);
}
```

9. Print-Specific Additions

Skip this section for web or screen-based assets.

1. **Colour mode:** Convert all hex colours to CMYK for professional printing. Screen pinks often look different in CMYK — proof before final print.
2. **Bleed:** For posters and marketing collateral, add 3mm bleed on all sides.
3. **Powder Pink on paper:** Test on your specific paper stock. On uncoated paper, it may need to be deepened to Dusty Rose to remain visible.

4. **Minimum line weight:** 0.25pt for any visible line or border.
5. **Image resolution:** 300 DPI minimum for print, 150 DPI for large-format posters viewed from distance.
6. **Avoid transparency effects** in print — flatten before export.

10. Design Principles (The Non-Negotiables)

These apply to **every surface, every format, every artefact**.

1. **Warmth over coldness.** Every neutral leans warm. No blue-greys, no pure blacks, no sterile whites.
2. **Restraint over decoration.** If an element doesn't serve the content, remove it.
3. **Equal treatment for equal items.** Cards, list items, blocks, sections — siblings share identical styling. No random colour variation between items of equal weight.
4. **Pink is a whisper, not a shout.** It appears in borders, dividers, labels, numbering, and subtle highlights — never as a dominant background fill.
5. **Typography carries the hierarchy.** Size, weight, and spacing do the structural work. Colour and decoration are secondary.
6. **Generous breathing room.** When in doubt, increase the spacing. The design should feel spacious and unhurried — never cramped.
7. **Consistency across surfaces.** A card on the web should *feel* like a card in a presentation should *feel* like a card in a printed report. Same colours, same proportions, same typographic hierarchy. The medium changes; the identity doesn't.